Tutorials

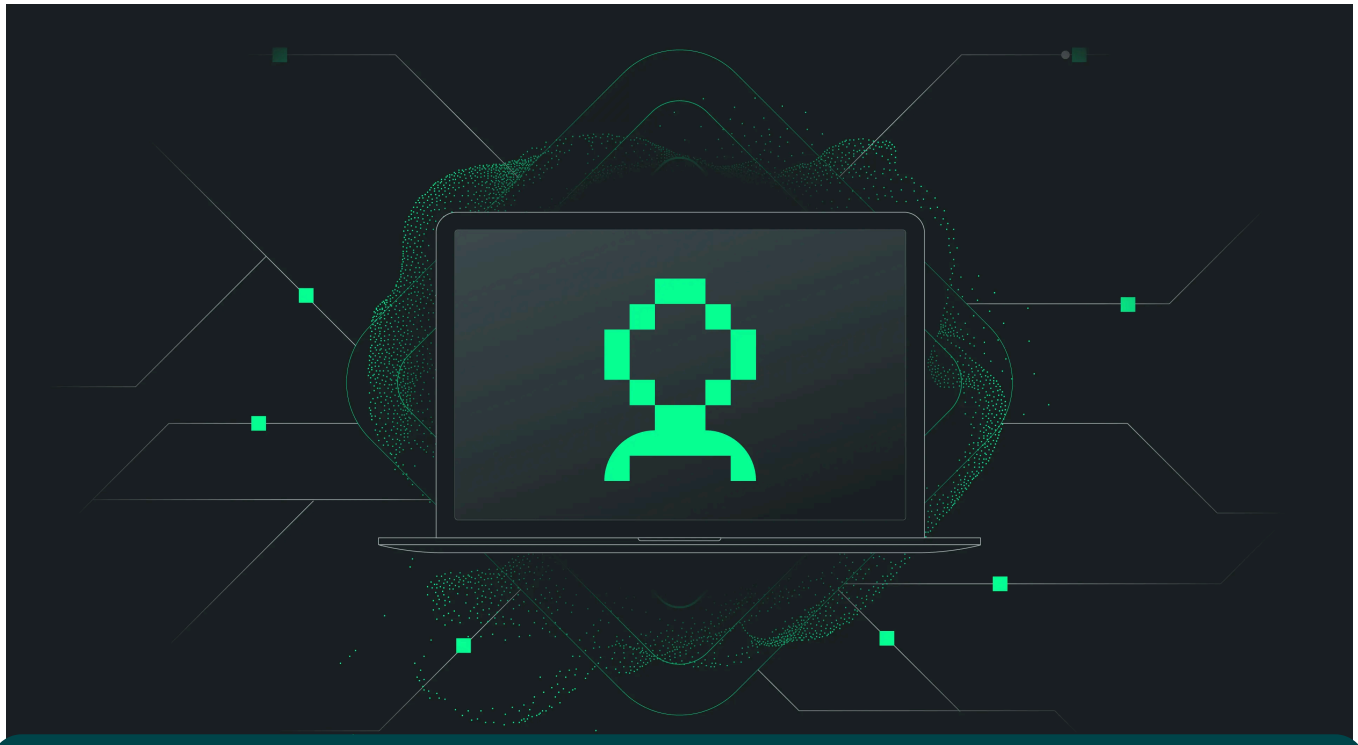
Remove your information from the web

Clean up your digital footprint across the web and social apps

Casey Ford, PhD
Communications Lead

May 15, 2025
7 mins read

Table of contents



Try NymVPN for free

Share

Your digital footprint is larger than you think. From public records to data broker databases, personal information about you is collected, indexed, and traded every day. If you care about privacy, knowing how to remove your information from the web isn't just helpful — it's essential to protect your privacy.

Nym's guide will walk you through how to reduce your online exposure and proactively safeguard your data. Whether you want to clean up search engine results, delete old accounts, or strengthen your online defenses, this is where to start.

Why is your personal info on the Internet?

Most people never knowingly consent to the scale at which their data is shared. Yet your name, location, contact info, and even behavioral patterns are often accessible online due to:

- **Public records** indexed by search engines
- **Data broker** networks scraping social platforms and forums
- Marketing lists and **cookie-based trackers**
- **Data breaches** of services you once signed up for

Privacy online is not the default: data exposure is. But it's possible to reduce how much of your life is searchable. Let's start with what shows up in Google.

How to remove personal info from Google Search

If you've found personal information in search results, Google provides a formal process

Try NymVPN for free

Use Google's Removal Tool

Contact the source website

Opt out of data broker sites

Data brokers aggregate and resell personal data, often without our consent. While removing yourself from every list isn't easy, opting out from major players can significantly reduce your exposure.

Major data brokers to know about

How to opt out of data broker collections

Delete old accounts and posts

Try NymVPN for free

you'd rather keep offline.

How to find and remove old accounts

Cleaning up social media

Social media platforms retain more than just posts: they store metadata, tags, and interaction history. Cleaning up old content helps reduce your digital footprint and limits how your past activity can be aggregated, profiled, or resurfaced.

How to delete personal info from Facebook

Facebook stores a vast amount of data, including your posts, photos, likes, and metadata like location tags. Here's how to clean it up:

Deleting specific Facebook posts

Deactivating or deleting your Facebook account

Try NymVPN for free

How to delete personal info from Instagram

Instagram, owned by Meta, links visual content to personal identity and location. Here's how to remove that data:

Deleting individual Instagram posts

Removing likes, comments, or story activity

Deactivating or deleting your Instagram account

How to delete personal info from X (Twitter)

X holds real-time posts, replies, DMs, and profile data that can be archived or scraped — even years after posting.

Deleting X tweets manually

Try NymVPN for free

Deactivating or deleting your X account

Clear stored personal info from your browser

Your browser collects a significant amount of personal data, from autofill credentials to browsing history. Clearing this data is a key step toward stronger privacy.

On Chrome

On Firefox

On Safari (Mac)

Privacy tools to prevent future exposure

Once you’ve cleaned up existing data, the next step is prevention. These tools limit future data collection and strengthen your ongoing privacy posture.

Try NymVPN for free

- **Virtual Private Networks (VPNs)** – Masks your IP and encrypts your internet traffic. Decentralized options like NymVPN use mixnet-based routing for maximum metadata protection
- **Password manager:** Securely stores unique passwords for each site to prevent reuse and breaches
- **Ad & tracker blockers:** Stops third-party cookies and tracking pixels from monitoring your activity (e.g., uBlock Origin, Privacy Badger)
- **Private search engines:** Search engines like DuckDuckGo & Brave don't log your queries or create user profiles

NymVPN goes beyond traditional VPNs by hiding not just your traffic, but also the patterns that metadata can expose. It's an essential tool for serious privacy.

Try NymVPN for free today

Removing info from the web helps your online privacy

Try NymVPN for free

significantly limit what's visible, shared, or exploited.

Start by cleaning up what already exists. Then shift toward prevention by using privacy-preserving tools like NymVPN, which masks your metadata and traffic with advanced, decentralized routing.

Online privacy isn't a setting: it's a system. And taking control of that system starts here.

Frequently Asked Questions: Removing your info from web

- Can I use a paid service to remove my data?
- Is deleting my data a one-time process?
- What if someone maliciously posted my info?
- Does a VPN erase my online history?

About the authors

Try NymVPN for free

Casey Ford, PhD

Communications Lead

Casey is the Head of Communications, lead writer, and editorial reviewer at Nym. He holds a PhD in Philosophy and researches the intersection of decentralized technologies and social life.

Keep Reading...

Privacy

What is metadata & what can it reveal about you?

Understanding the raw material of digital surveillance

March 3, 2025 12 mins read

Privacy

What is my IP address?

How anyone can see where you are and track what you're doing online

February 24, 2025 10 mins read

Privacy

NymVPN, Web3 privacy, Network

Try NymVPN for free

What are data brokers? And how they quietly track your every move

Understand how your personal data is sold — and how to stop it at the source

April 10, 2025 6 mins read

Nym is more than a VPN

The first app that protects you from AI surveillance thanks to a noise-generating mixnet

November 26, 2024 8 mins read

Nym Newsletter

Enter your email address

I agree to the processing of my personal data in accordance with the Privacy Policy

WIREGUARD IS A REGISTERED TRADEMARK OF JASON A. DONENFELD

© 2025 NYM TECHNOLOGIES SA. ALL RIGHTS RESERVED.